

Philipp Eschenbach

CHIEF TECHNOLOGY OFFICER

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CTO with expertise in Java, Kotlin, Micronaut, AI, and cloud-native architectures. Passionate about scaling teams and modernizing tech stacks.

EXPERIENCE

Mercanis (CdC3 GmbH)

Nov 2025 – Present

VP Engineering & AI

Leading engineering for an enterprise procurement platform, doubling the team and launching a next-generation agentic AI platform.

- Doubled the engineering organization from ~20 to ~40 engineers within the first six months, while raising the hiring bar and strengthening engineering culture.
- Conceived and launched a new agentic AI platform, establishing the foundation for the company's next generation of intelligent procurement products.
- Championed Agentic Engineering practices across the organization, embedding AI-assisted development into everyday workflows and dramatically accelerating delivery velocity.
- Partnered closely with sales and delivery teams to win and onboard enterprise customers, driving technical pre-sales, solution design, and complex integration processes.

Legal Hero GmbH

Sep 2021 – Oct 2025

Chief Technology Officer

Building and scaling the engineering team, modernizing tech stack, and driving AI initiatives.

- Scaled the engineering "team" of 1 full-stack Developer, growing it to 12 developers with strong expertise in Backend, Frontend, AI and DevOps.
- Migrated from a monolithic Groovy (Grails) Application to a modern microservices setup using Kotlin and Micronaut, significantly improving performance, scalability, and maintainability.
- Implemented a Kubernetes (K8s) cluster, improving system reliability and scalability while reducing deployment complexity.
- Defined and executed the technology roadmap, aligning engineering efforts with business objectives.
- Launched AI-driven automation projects, including self-trained models to support operational teams and enhance platform effectiveness.

Culcha GmbH

Apr 2021 – Present

Chief Technology Officer, (late) Co-Founder and Managing Director

Led technical development, moving the platform from MVP to production-ready status.

- Transitioned the product from an MVP to a fully scalable, production-ready application, ensuring high availability and performance.
- Designed and implemented a backend architecture using Kotlin and Micronaut, reducing response times and improving system maintainability.
- Led a product organization of 8 people (engineering, product, design), improving cross-functional collaboration and accelerating development speed.
- Developed and integrated predictive analytics to enhance user engagement and content creation.

uberall GmbH

Aug 2018 – Jan 2021

VP Engineering

Scaled the engineering team and introduced microservices architecture.

- Grew the engineering team from 20 to 60 developers, improving hiring processes and fostering a strong engineering culture.
- Transitioned the development structure from a traditional backend/frontend model to a squad-based engineering setup, increasing agility and cross-team collaboration.
- Led all Engineering Managers, ensuring effective leadership and alignment across teams.
- Introduced microservices with Micronaut, reducing system complexity and improving scalability.

uberall GmbH

Jul 2013 – Jul 2018

Lead Backend Developer

Led the backend team and modernized infrastructure.

- Managed a team of 7 backend developers, fostering growth and technical excellence.
- Designed and deployed cloud infrastructure on AWS, improving system resilience and reducing costs.
- Executed a zero-downtime migration to AWS, ensuring smooth service transition without impact on customers.
- Implemented Docker and Jenkins-based CI/CD pipelines, significantly accelerating deployment cycles.

SKILLS

Development

TypeScript · Python · Kotlin · Java · React · Next.js · Node.js · NestJS · Groovy · Grails

Architecture & Infrastructure

Microservices · Micronaut · Spring Boot · Event-Driven Architectures · Scalable Systems

DevOps

Kubernetes · AWS · Docker · Terraform · CI/CD · Jenkins · GitHub Actions

Agentic AI

LLM Agents · LangChain · LangGraph · MCP (Model Context Protocol) · RAG · Vector Databases · LLM Observability · Prompt Engineering · Agent Orchestration

AI & Data Engineering

AI/ML Model Training · Predictive Analytics · NLP · Data Pipelines

Leadership & Strategy

Engineering Leadership · Scaling Teams · Agile & Squad-Based Structures · Technology Roadmaps

LANGUAGES

German Native speaker

English Fluent